

Responsibility Assignment Standard - (RAS-A)

OriginID: OOF-OID-AGA-RASA-2026-06-17-0012
Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™
Architecture Family: Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™)
Operational Layer: Responsibility Assignment Governance Layer
Governed Space: Responsibility Assignment Governance
Category: Governance & Enforcement
Subcategory: Accountability Governance Architecture
Type: Parent Standard
Version: 1.0
Status: Canonical · Open Standard
Origin Date: 17 June 2026
Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Accountability Governance Architecture (AGA™) · Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS) · Authority Governance Standard (AGS) · Authority Delegation Standard (ADS) · Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS) · INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard
AI-Readable: Yes
Authority: OOF
Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property
Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Responsibility Assignment Standard (RAS-A) defines the structural conditions under which responsibilities may be assigned, allocated, transferred, accepted, recorded, governed, reconstructed, and enforced while preserving legitimacy, traceability, accountability, clarity, and operational validity throughout the responsibility-assignment lifecycle.

RAS-A governs responsibility assignment.

The standard establishes the foundational conditions required to determine who assigned responsibility, to whom responsibility was assigned, what responsibility was assigned, whether the assignment was valid, and whether the assigned responsibility remained governable.

Responsibility does not become operationally valid merely because a task exists.

Responsibility becomes governable when it is properly assigned.

RAS-A governs that assignment.

A. Standard Abstract

Every governance system assigns responsibility.

Organizations assign responsibility.

Contractors assign responsibility.

Supervisors assign responsibility.

Institutions assign responsibility.

AI orchestration systems increasingly assign responsibility.

Human-AI environments require responsibility assignment governance.

Without responsibility-assignment governance:

- duties become unclear
- task ownership becomes fragmented
- responsibility gaps emerge
- responsibility conflicts increase
- accountability becomes weakened
- operational failures become harder to reconstruct

RAS-A exists to govern these conditions.

B. Core Principle

Responsibility assignment becomes valid only when assigned responsibilities remain identifiable, legitimate, accepted, traceable, reconstructable, accountable, and operationally valid throughout the responsibility- assignment lifecycle.

C. Scope

This standard may apply to:

- organizations
 - institutions
 - governments
 - contractor networks
 - subcontractor chains
 - temporary workforce environments
 - supervisory systems
 - operational task assignment
 - compliance environments
 - AI systems
 - autonomous agents
 - orchestrated agent systems
 - Human-AI operational environments
 - robotics ecosystems
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- future intelligent governance systems

RAS-A applies wherever responsibility is assigned to an actor, system, role, organization, agent, or operational entity.

D. Why This Standard Exists

Responsibility governance requires more than identifying responsibility.

Governance must also determine how responsibility was assigned.

Common failures include:

- unclear task assignment
- undocumented responsibility allocation
- assignment to the wrong actor
- assignment without authority
- assignment without acceptance
- assignment without capability
- overlapping assignments
- abandoned assignments
- hidden responsibility transfers

The challenge is not only determining who was responsible.

The challenge is determining whether responsibility was validly assigned.

RAS-A exists because responsibility assignment is a distinct governance space.

E. Responsibility Assignment Integrity Logic

Responsibility assignment integrity exists only when the following remain materially preservable:

1. Assignment Origin Integrity

The assignment remains attributable to a legitimate assignment source.

2. Assignment Scope Integrity

The assigned responsibility remains connected to clearly defined duties and boundaries.

3. Assignment Validity Integrity

The assignment remains legitimate, accepted, recognized, and operationally valid.

4. Assignment Traceability Integrity

The assignment remains reconstructable throughout the assignment lifecycle.

5. Assignment Accountability Integrity

The assignment remains connected to accountable governance structures and consequence-bearing relationships.

F. Operational Architecture Space

RAS-A defines the operational architecture space for:

- responsibility assignment governance
- task allocation governance
- duty assignment governance
- responsibility allocation
- assignment traceability
- assignment validity
- assignment accountability
- contractor responsibility assignment
- Human-AI responsibility assignment
- agent responsibility assignment
- operational duty governance

This space exists because responsibility must be assigned before it can be fulfilled, traced, enforced, or connected to accountability.

RAS-A governs whether responsibility assignment remains valid.

G. Difference Between Responsibility and Responsibility Assignment

Responsibility defines the duty to act.

Responsibility assignment defines how that duty is allocated to a specific actor.

Responsibility may exist as an obligation.

Assignment determines who carries that obligation.

RGS governs responsibility.

RAS-A governs responsibility assignment.

Both are required.

H. Runtime Position

RAS-A operates within the Responsibility Layer of AGA™.

It follows:

- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)
- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Authority Delegation Standard (ADS)
- Authority Validation Standard (AVS)
- Authority Escalation Standard (AES)
- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)

and supports:

- Responsibility Continuity Standard (RCS)
- Responsibility Traceability Standard (RTS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

RAS-A governs how responsibility becomes assigned before governance evaluates continuity, traceability, capability, control, oversight, evidence, or accountability.

I. Responsibility Assignment Failure Rule

Responsibility assignment failure occurs when responsibility assignments cannot be reliably identified, validated, accepted, reconstructed, governed, enforced, or connected to accountable governance structures.

Examples include:

- undocumented assignment
- unclear assignment
- assignment without authority
- assignment to an incapable actor
- assignment without acceptance
- overlapping responsibility assignment
- hidden responsibility transfer
- responsibility-assignment gaps

RAS-A exists to expose and govern these conditions.

J. Validity Logic

A responsibility-assignment environment is valid under RAS-A when:

- assignment sources remain identifiable
- assigned duties remain clearly defined

- assignment legitimacy remains demonstrable
- assignment acceptance remains reviewable
- assignment history remains reconstructable
- assignment accountability remains preservable
- assigned responsibilities remain operationally valid

A responsibility-assignment environment becomes invalid when:

- assignment origin is unknown
- assigned duties are unclear
- assignment authority cannot be demonstrated
- assignment acceptance is absent or unverifiable
- assignment history cannot be reconstructed
- assignment accountability is lost

K. Relationship to Other OOF Standards

RAS-A derives from:

- Responsibility Governance Standard (RGS)
- Authority Governance Standard (AGS)
- Relationship Accountability Standard (RAS)

and supports:

- Responsibility Continuity Standard (RCS)
- Responsibility Traceability Standard (RTS)
- Capability Readiness Governance Standard (CRGS)
- Chain of Control Standard (CCS)
- Evidence Accountability Standard (EAS)
- Accountability Governance Standard (AGS-A)

RGS governs responsibility.

RAS-A governs assignment of responsibility.

RCS governs whether responsibility remains preserved.

RTS governs whether responsibility can be reconstructed.

L. Foundational Principle

Responsibility cannot be enforced if responsibility was never validly assigned.

Canonical Closing Statement

Responsibility Assignment Standard (RAS-A) defines the structural conditions under which responsibilities may be assigned, allocated, transferred, accepted, recorded, governed, reconstructed, and enforced while preserving legitimacy, traceability, accountability, clarity, and operational validity throughout the responsibility-assignment lifecycle.

Responsibility becomes governable only when assignment is clear. If responsibility assignment cannot be identified, validated, accepted, or reconstructed, accountability becomes unreliable.

Module Architecture

→ RAOIM — Responsibility Assignment Origin Integrity Module

→ RASIM — Responsibility Assignment Scope Integrity Module

→ RAVIM — Responsibility Assignment Validity Integrity Module

→ RATIM — Responsibility Assignment Traceability Integrity Module

→ RAAIM — Responsibility Assignment Accountability Integrity Module

Related Documents

→ About the Responsibility Assignment Standard - (RAS-A)

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